

Hard Disk Disconnect

S.K. Saikia

Q I have a P-III 500 MHz computer with a 10 GB HD (two equal partitions) and 256 MB of SD RAM running Windows 98 SE. Recently, I was running out of disk space, so I added a new 40 GB HDD (with three partitions) and installed Windows 2000 Professional on the first partition (this was done with the original HD disconnected). Now, I have a problem. To choose the OS at start up, I have to enter the BIOS setup and change the boot-up disk select to make the choice. Is there an easier way to toggle between the two OSes? Or, is there a boot manager to tackle my problem?

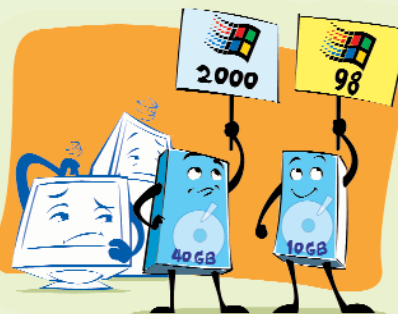


Illustration Shyam Shriram

A Yes, there are some boot managers you could use. You could try the Partition Boot Manager (www.sadepvelopment.com/) or the OSL2000 Boot Manager (www.osloader.com/).

However, if you are not too keen on using this method, the alternate manual solution is that you must reinstall both your OSes with *both* hard drives connected. Simply reinstalling the

OS will not cause data loss, but as a safety precaution, back up anyway!

newer version is available, so I click the update link and I download and install it. However, after I install, the next time I start Messenger it shows the same message. Even when I tried the bundled Windows Messenger from the root directory (C:\Program Files\messenger 6.2\msnmgs.exe), the same message appears. What do I do?

Arun Thampi

A Windows XP has two messengers; Windows Messenger and MSN Messenger. The latest version for MSN Messenger is 6.2. The directory where you are starting from is that of MSN Messenger and NOT Windows Messenger. The directory for Windows Messenger is C:\Program Files\Messenger, where C: is your default Windows directory.

You can download the latest version of Windows messenger from www.microsoft.com/windows/messenger/download.asp or you can find the latest version of MSN messenger on this month's Digit DVD. Or, head to <http://messenger.msn.com>. If the problem persists, uninstall both messengers and delete their folders, and reinstall the latest versions manually.

However, you cannot sign into both messengers at the same time using the same ID. MSN Messenger is better and has frequent updates; we recommend you use it.

Convert to PDF

Q I have a Pentium III 866 MHz, 192MB of SDRAM, a 20 GB HDD, Windows Me, and Adobe Reader 6.0. I want to know if we can convert scanned documents into PDF documents.

Mihir Kulkarni

A It is possible to convert various image files such as JPEG, TIFF and BMP to PDF. However, for that, you need Adobe Writer. Adobe Reader cannot be used for this purpose. You can try some of the freeware available off the Net—for example, "Convert Image to PDF," available at www.softinterfacer.com



Multiple Excel Windows

Q In Windows 98 SE with MS Office 2000, six to seven Microsoft Excel programs start when Windows 98 starts up, and in every instance, it asks whether to enable or disable macros. Even when running any other application, Excel starts, asking whether to enable or disable macros. When I try to shutdown or restart the computer, Excel starts. Only Windows Explorer and My Computer work properly. When browsing for files, the Excel icon is not shown in My Documents. This has happened when I copied some Excel files from my friend. When I tried looking for viruses, it showed a "wyx boot sector virus," iworm.blebla.in and w32.pesin.A. All these were repaired, but the viruses persist...

Sandip Thakkar

A It appears you have contracted a Macro virus. To clean this, update your virus definitions and scan your system. It should delete/clean the file. The reason for the problem is that the virus is trying to run a macro on your system and since the macros warning is enabled in Excel, the warning is flashed every time it tries to run it.

I Want My Video, Too

Q I have an assembled a PC with an Intel P IV 1.7 GHz processor and a 40 GB HDD with 256 MB



Change your Excel Macro settings here